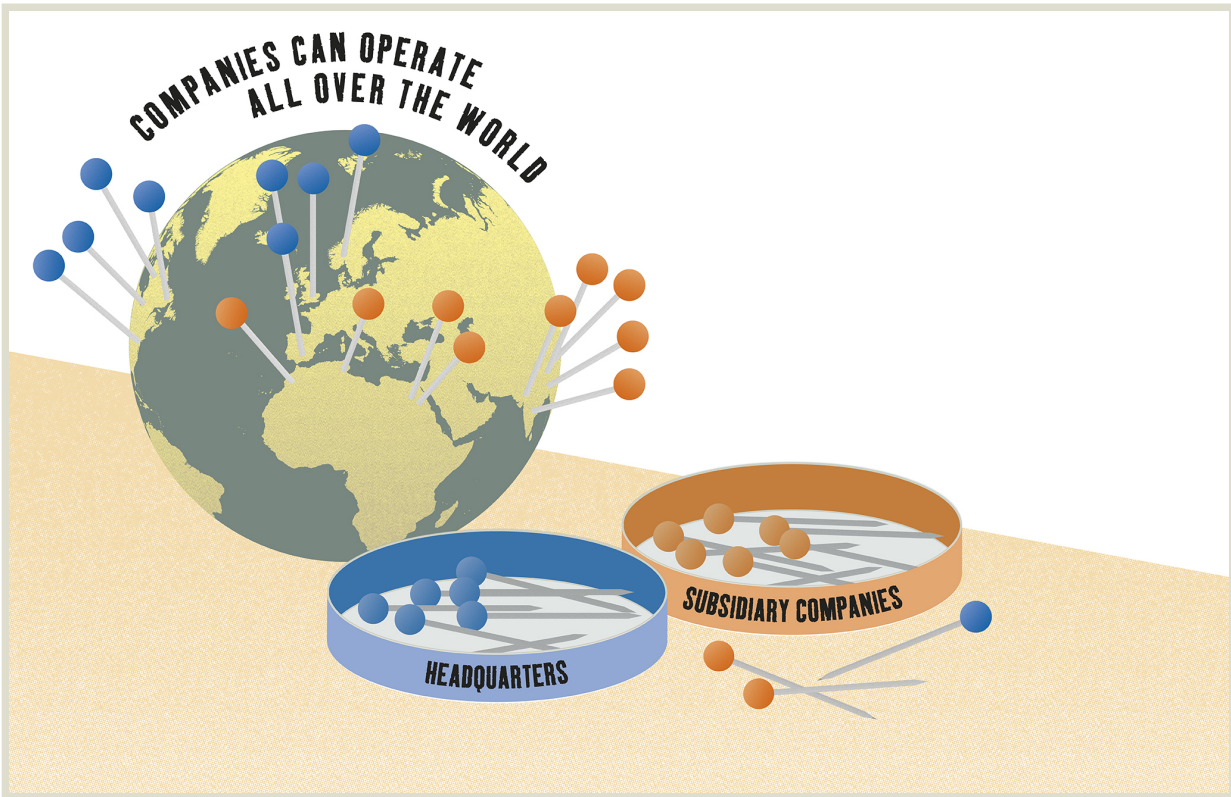




Global business

Large companies tend to have their headquarters in rich countries but often produce goods in poorer, developing countries to save on transportation and labor costs.

Going global

In general, there has been a steady trend toward globalization, with increasingly free trade worldwide. Big companies have taken advantage of the opportunity to sell their products to different countries, and many now have customers all over the world. Some firms such as supermarket chains or fast-food restaurants have opened outlets in other countries to sell their goods or services.

There are also large corporations that not only sell their products abroad, but also produce the goods in other countries. These so-called transnational, or multinational, companies are generally based in rich, developed countries where they have their headquarters. Although the company is owned and managed from here, it may produce little or none of the goods in its home